

# Hanieh Amiryousefi

MSc Candidate · Mind, Brain & Behavior  
Visual Perception Researcher

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## RESEARCH PROFILE

Perception researcher with a background in psychology and hands-on lab experience in material and face perception. My work sits at the intersection of low-level visual processing and higher-level social cognition, specifically, how physical properties of faces (lighting, surface material, dynamics) shape trustworthiness judgments. I am drawn to human visual research that keeps people at the center.

## EDUCATION

### MSc Mind, Brain and Behavior (MBB)

Oct 2024 – Present

Justus Liebig University Giessen, Germany · Field: Psychology & Neuroscience  
Current Grade: 1.5 (German scale, ongoing), equivalent to "Very Good"

### BSc Psychology

Sep 2019 – Sep 2023

Khayyam University, Mashhad, Iran · Final grade: 17.43 / 20 (Iranian scale, max 20)  
equivalent to "Very Good"

## PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & CERTIFICATES

### fMRI Data Acquisition, Analysis & Safety Training

Oct 2025 – Mar 2026

Bender Institute of Neuroimaging (BION), JLU Giessen

- Supervisors: Prof. Ben de Haas & Dr. Carlo R. Blecker

### EEG Experiment Design and Data Analysis Training

Oct 2025 – Mar 2026

Action, Perception & Multisensory Integration Lab, JLU Giessen

- Completed comprehensive training in EEG experimental design and data analysis methodologies
- Trained under the supervision of Prof. Dr. Katja Fiehler and Micha Engeser

### Comprehensive Training Course on Cognitive Rehabilitation

May – Jun 2024

In Psychiatric and Neurological Disorders · Synapse Scientific Group

### Introduction to Cognitive Assessment and Rehabilitation

Dec 2023

Institution: National Brain Mapping Lab (NBML)

### Transcranial Current Stimulation in Alzheimer's-type Dementia

Sep 2021

Institution: National Brain Mapping Lab (NBML)

### Introduction to Cognitive Psychology Webinar

Sep 2021

Institution: National Brain Mapping Lab (NBML)

## HONOURS AND AWARDS

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### Master's Research Scholarship

The Adaptive Mind (DFG-funded Excellence Cluster)

Funded to conduct advanced perception research for Master's thesis under the supervision of Prof. Dr. Katja Dörschner-Boyaci and Prof. Dr. Katharina Dobs.

### Online Scholarship Awards

*e-fellows.net*

Selected for the talent network and career development program based on academic and merit achievements.

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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### Research Assistant at the Visual Cognition & Computational Neuroscience Lab (VCCN)

*Prof. Katharina Dobs · Justus Liebig University Giessen*

*Jan 2026 – Present*

- Working on face perception experiments with a computational neuroscience angle
- Designing and running psychophysical studies on facial processing

### Research Assistant at the Perception & Active Exploration Lab (PACE)

*Mar – Dec 2025*

*Prof. Katja Dörschner-Boyaci · Justus Liebig University Giessen*

- Assisted in experiments on material perception and visual surface properties
- Gained hands-on experience with psychophysics methodology and stimulus design

## PROJECTS

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### Master's Thesis (ongoing)

*Apr 2026 – Present*

*The Interactive Effects of Lip Material Appearance and Facial Dynamics on Perceived Facial Trustworthiness under Paramount Lighting*

Examining how lip gloss (matte vs. glossy) and facial dynamics (static vs. dynamic) interact with lighting direction to shape trustworthiness judgments across photorealistic avatars

### Gloss Perception Modelling with Deep Learning

*Oct 2025 – Mar 2026*

Trained CNN models (ResNet-50) to predict human gloss perception ratings from image features

Tools: Python, PyTorch, scikit-learn

### EEG Study: Neural Encoding of Scene Transitions

*Apr – Aug 2025*

Investigated how the brain encodes visual scene boundaries using multivariate decoding approaches

### BSc Thesis: Sleep Quality and Academic Burnout in Adolescents

*2022 – 2023*

Examined the relationship between sleep quality and academic burnout in high school students

Tools: SPSS, Pittsburgh Sleep Quality Index, Academic Burnout Questionnaire, online survey design (Porsline)

## OTHER EXPERIENCES

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### Student Assistant at the University Computing Center (HRZ)

*Apr 2026 – Present*

*Justus Liebig University Giessen*

- Producing and designing interactive educational content and digital media for the department
- Filming, editing, and managing the post-production workflow of university lectures and course materials

**Active Contributor, Psychology Student Council (FSR) | JLU Giessen** *Apr 2026 – Present*

- Collaborating with the student council to support departmental initiatives and address student concerns
- Supporting and guiding international MBB students to successfully navigate academic challenges

## DIGITAL & TECHNICAL SKILLS

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### Neuroimaging, Behavioral & Data Analysis

EEG (64-channel ActiCAP, FieldTrip), fMRI (SPM12), MVPA/LDA decoding, ERP analysis, GLM, DeepLabCut (pose estimation & movement tracking)

### Programming & Scripting

Python (Scikit-learn, pandas, matplotlib, scipy), MATLAB

### Deep Learning & AI

PyTorch, CNNs, transfer learning, linear probing, ResNet-50, Jupyter Notebook

### Experimental Design & Stimulus Creation

PsychoPy, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Blender, Unity, Unreal Engine

### Version Control

Git, GitHub [github.com/Whoishanie/gloss-perception](https://github.com/Whoishanie/gloss-perception)

### Statistical Analysis

SPSS, FDR correction, regression, correlation analysis

### Psychological Assessment

NEO-PI-R, MMPI-2, WAIS scales

## LANGUAGES

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- English – C1 (Advanced)
- Persian – Native
- German – A1 (Beginner, actively developing)

## REFERENCES

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References available upon request

### Prof. Katharina Dobs

*Visual Cognition & Computational Neuroscience Lab · JLU Giessen*

[katharina.dobs@psychol.uni-giessen.de](mailto:katharina.dobs@psychol.uni-giessen.de)

### Prof. Katja Dörschner-Boyaci

*Perception & Active Exploration Lab · JLU Giessen*

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### Dr. Arash Akbarinia

*Assistant Professor, Lancaster University Leipzig*

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